

Rodent groups

Over 40 per cent of the world's mammals are rodents. They come in many shapes and sizes.



Hamster: this creature comes from Western Asia and is a very popular pet.



Squirrel: it is an excellent tree climber and uses its tail for balance.



Vole: water voles live by rivers and lakes and make burrows in the banks.



Naked mole rat: it lives underground and burrows with flat feet.



Porcupine: this animal has sharp quills that it raises when threatened.

Mice

Mice have pointed noses and long whiskers, which help them find their way around dark corners. This house mouse eats many different types of food and can produce 36,000 droppings in a year.

Harvest mice use their tails like hands, to grip onto stalks.



House mouse



Towns of rodents

Some rodents live on their own, but a lot of them, such as these prairie dogs, live in large underground communities called towns. Each town comprises a number of burrows connected by long tunnels.

Harvest mouse



A long, long sleep

The dormouse can be found in the woods and fields of Europe and is an excellent climber and jumper. It hibernates, or sleeps, for seven months during the winter without waking up.